



Dissertation: Commercialization of Marantaceae Species neglected Non-timber Forest Products (NTFPs) in Southern Cameroon
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The Message: Sustainable management of leaves used to wrap “BOBOLO” contributes to food affordability in Cameroon

Target audience: Women making “bobolo”, collectors of leaves, buyam-sellams, N.G.Os, C.I.Gs, MINADER, MINFOF, MINSANTE and MINCOM

Engaging stakeholders

Channels: Correspondence , Exchange workshop, Broadcasting

How: Policy Brief, deliberative forum and outreach, Community Radio Program



Policy Brief: Key Messages

1. Background:

- Leaves used to wrap “Bobolo” in Cameroon scientifically fall under the class Marantaceae.
- These leaves are used as wrapping materials, spoons, building of thatch houses and roots can be used to treat malnutrition

2. The Problem:

- “Bobolo” is a principal meal of the people of southern Cameroon but consumed throughout the country.. The demand for “Bobolo” is high and prices to afford are increasing.
- Women producing ‘bobolo ‘ mostly affirmed that the high price of the product is as a result of increase in leave price and not Cassava
- leaves prices augmented by 600 % between 1995 (20 f cfa/ Kg) and 2012 (120 f cfa /Kg). Consequently the price of “Bobolo” also rose from 25 fcfa to 100fcfa
- Buyam sellam of leaves complains on the scarcity of leaves from the collectors
- I observed that leaves are becoming scarce because collection is disorganized

3. Policy Options:

- **Option 1:** Collectors to focus on good harvesting practices through a management plan
- **Option 2:** Encourage collectors to plant the leaves.
- **Option 3:** Regulation of market price of leaves.

4. Implementation considerations:

- **O1:** Supervision of the implementation of the management plan
- **O2:** Train collectors with the required planting techniques.
- **O3:** Collectors to form market based cooperatives . Homologation of market prices

Expected effect:

- Leaves used to make “Bobolo” are properly managed.
- “Bobolo” is abundant in the market at a cheap price.